

Past Continuous Tense.



It is used to express a continued or ongoing action in past, an ongoing action which occurred in past and completed at some point in past. It expresses an ongoing nature of an action in past. For example, “he was laughing.” This sentence shows ongoing action (laughing) of a person which occurred in past. Past continuous tense is also called past progressive.

Rules:

Auxiliary verb “was or were” is used in sentence. 1st form of verb or base verb + ing (present participle) is used as main verb in sentence.

Examples:

1. She was crying yesterday.
2. They were listening songs.
3. He was talking on phone.

Structures.

1. Positive structure.

Subject+ Was/Were+ Main verb(4th form)+ object+.

Example.

1. He was reading a book.

2. Negative structure.

Subject+ Was/Were + not+ Main verb(4th form)+ Object+.

Example.

1. I was writing a letter.

3. Interrogative structure

Was/Were + Subject+ Main verb(4th form)+ Object+?

Example.

2. Were you going to Market last night?

4. Negative interrogative /Combine structure

Was/Were + subject+ not+ Main verb (4th form)+ object+?

Example.

1. Was she not attending your call?

5. Question word structure.

Q.W+ Was/Were+ Subject+ Main Verb (4th form)+ object+?

Example.

1. What were you telling me in the meeting?